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Developing data management support services in Switzerland

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Toronto

Alexandra Stam

UNIL | Université de Lausanne

Presentation overview

I. FORS at a glance

II. Data sharing and re-use culture in Switzerland

- The funder's side
- The researcher's side

III. Data management support services

- Data deposit and access
- Data management training and consultancy
- Website and guidelines

IV. Challenges and future directions

FORS at a glance

- Surveys (national and international)
- Research activities
- Data and research information services
  - Research inventory (9200 project descriptions)
  - Data service (400+ datasets)
  - Public statistics (15 surveys)
  - Social indicators
  - Data visualization
  - Data management

Data sharing and reuse culture in Switzerland

- The funder's side

Social science research is mainly funded by the Swiss National Science Foundation

  - No data management plan required
  - No guidance provided
  - Projects should be deposited but no monitoring or action

- The researcher's side

FORS conducts regular surveys among users

  - Lack of data sharing and re-use culture
  - Collection practices not consistent with sharing

Data management support services

- New deposit and access platform (FORSbase)
  - A work environment for social scientists
  - Support for the entire data life cycle
  - Integrated data storage for primary data and metadata
  - Data preparation and exchange via standards (SPSS, DDI, etc.)

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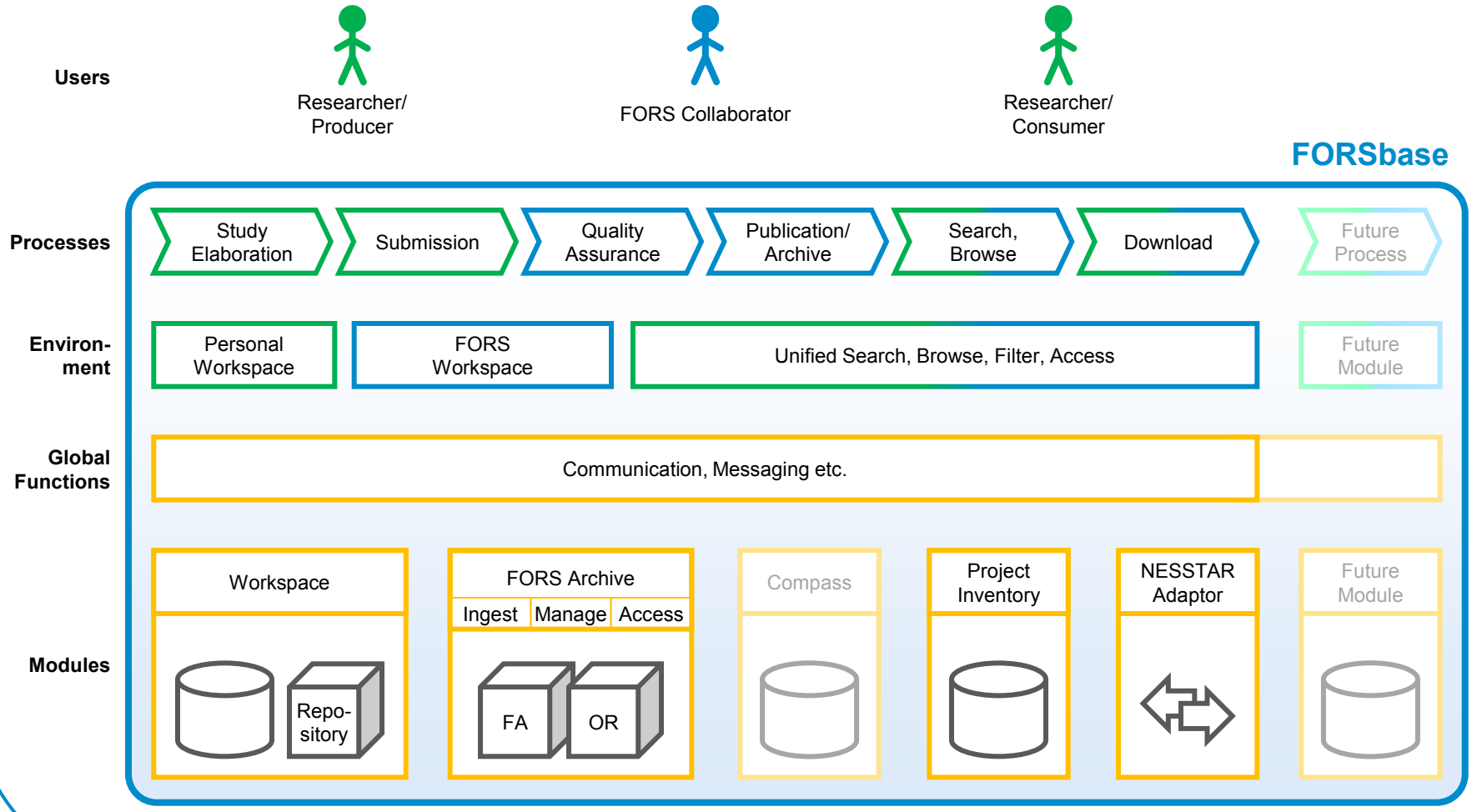
Big Picture FORSbase



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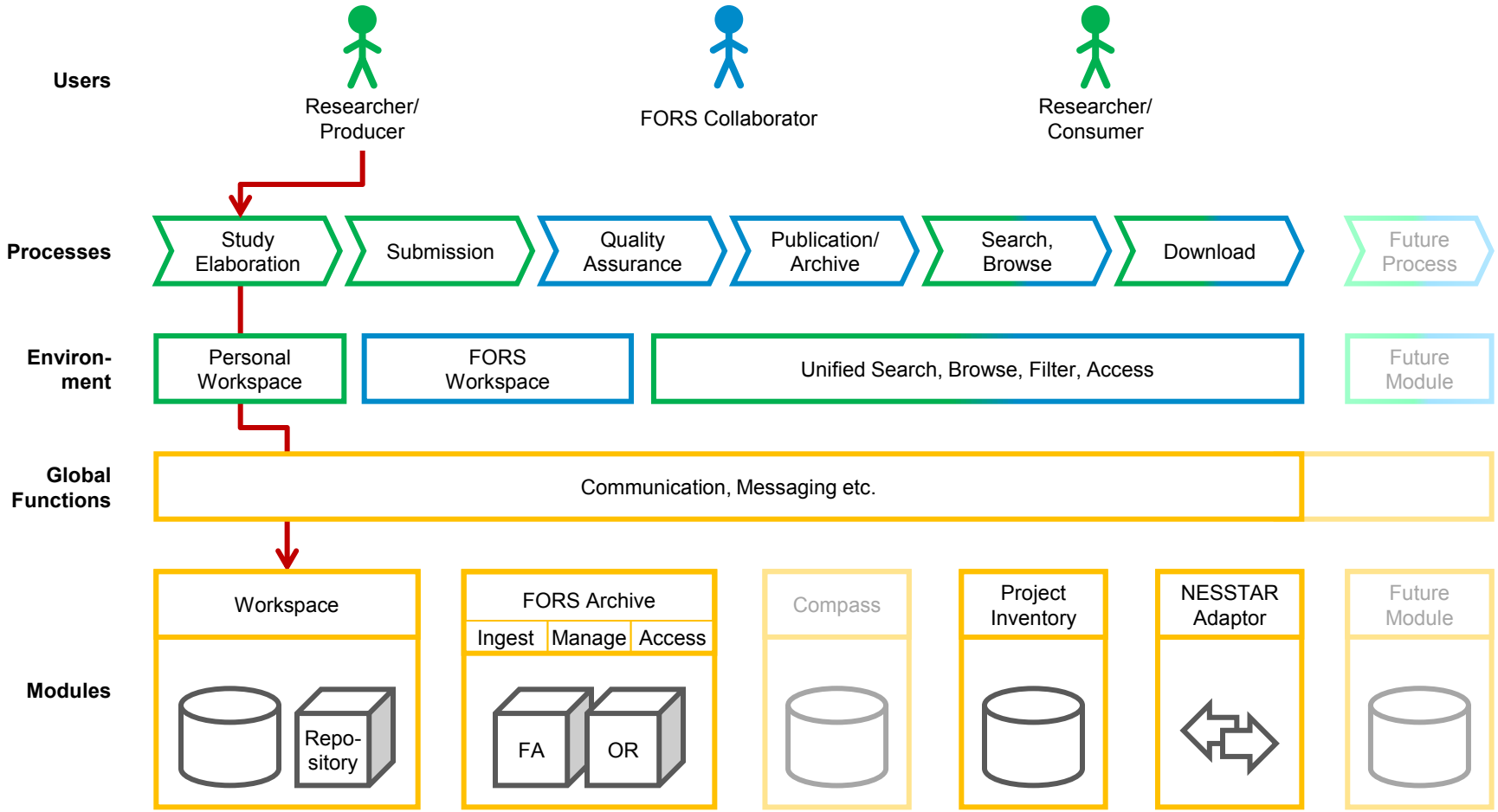

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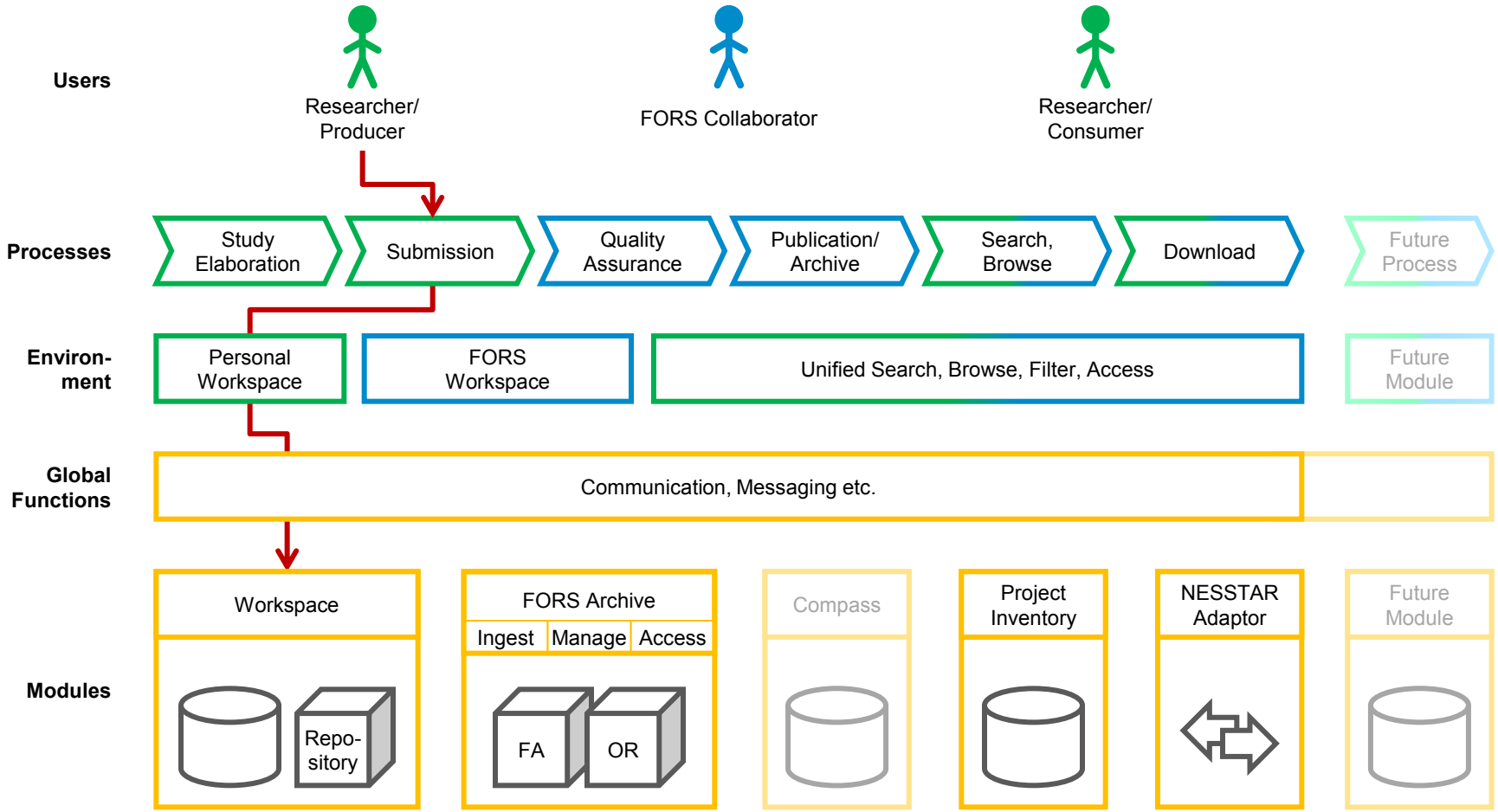

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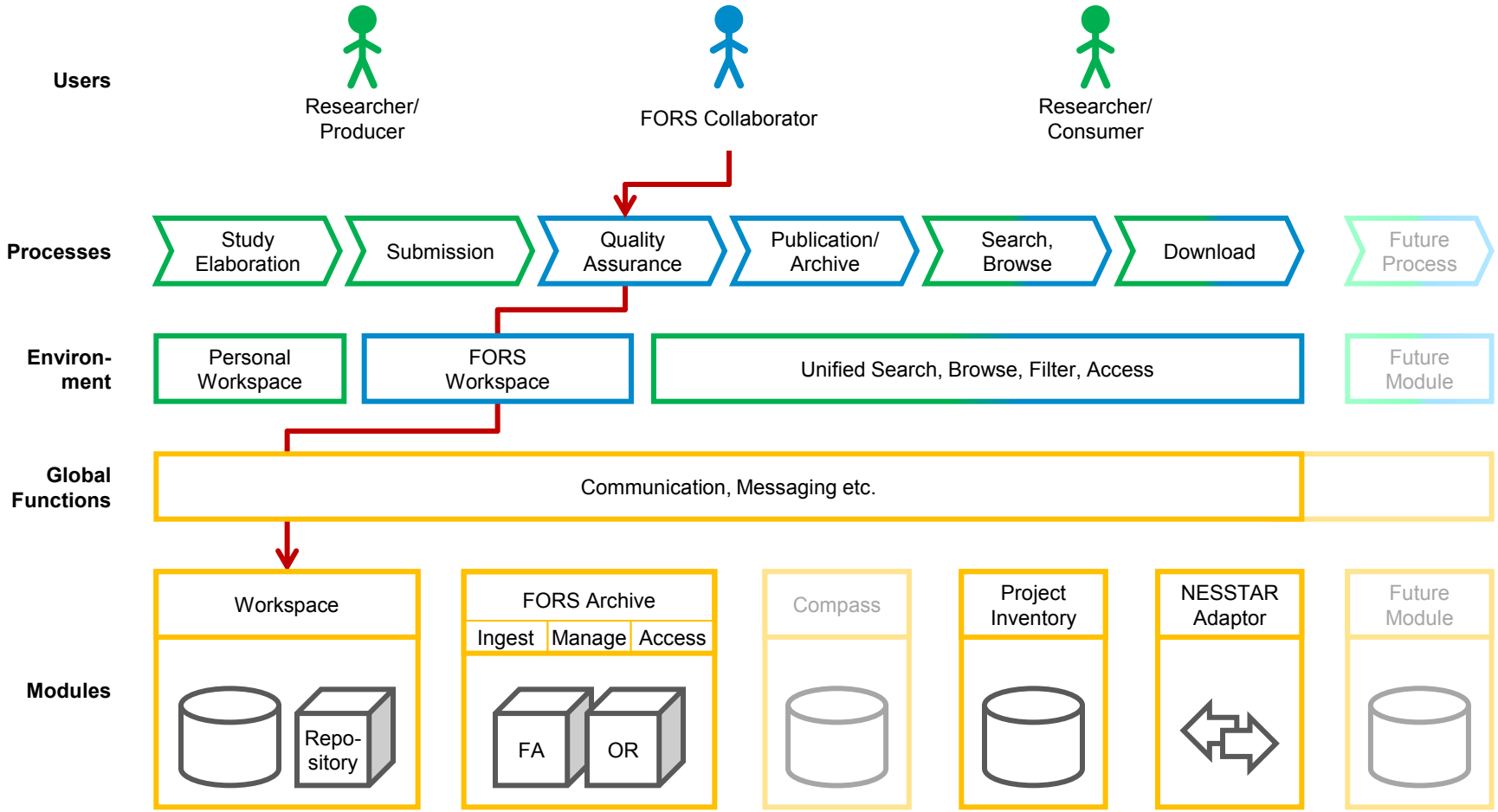

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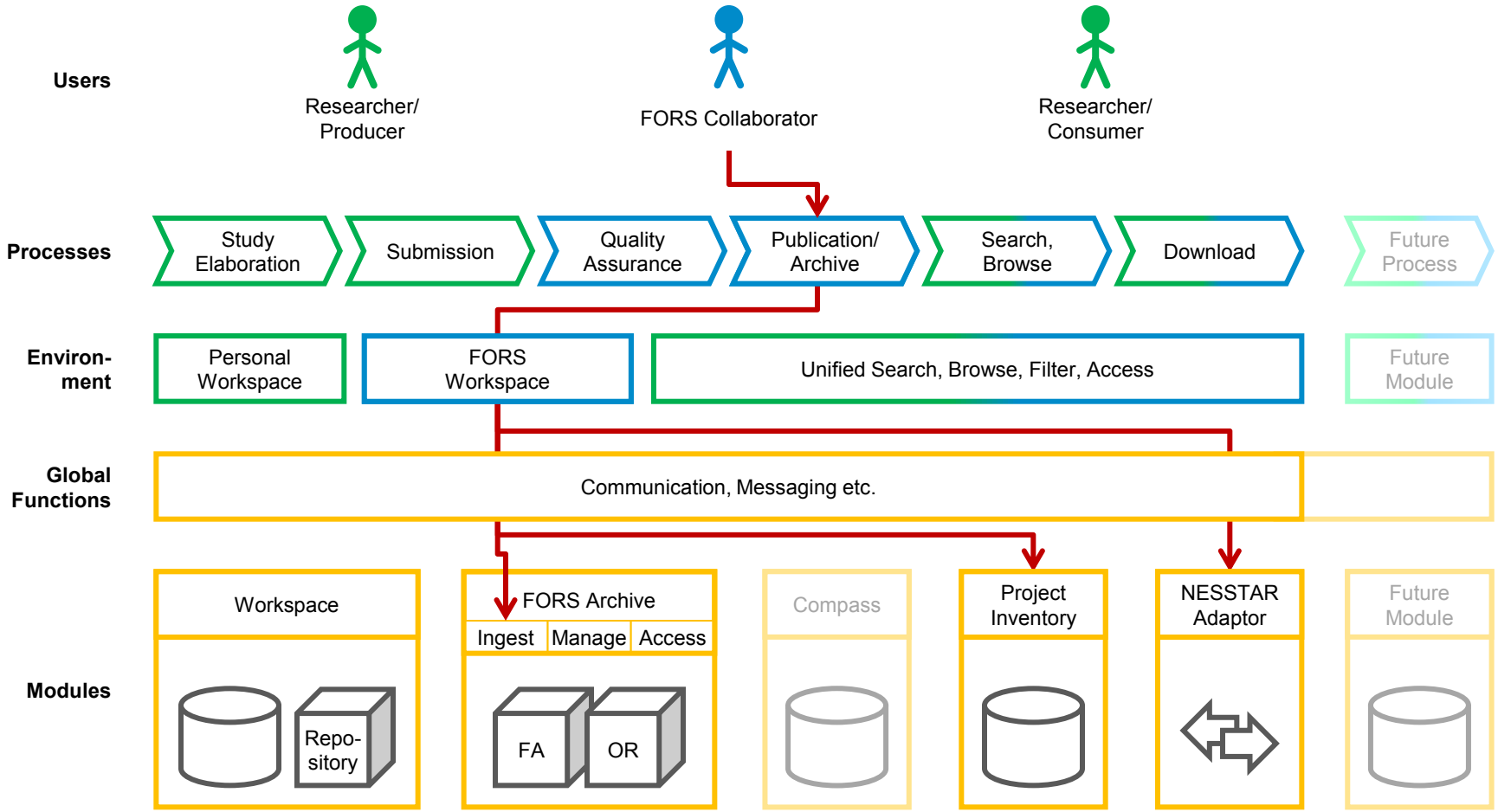

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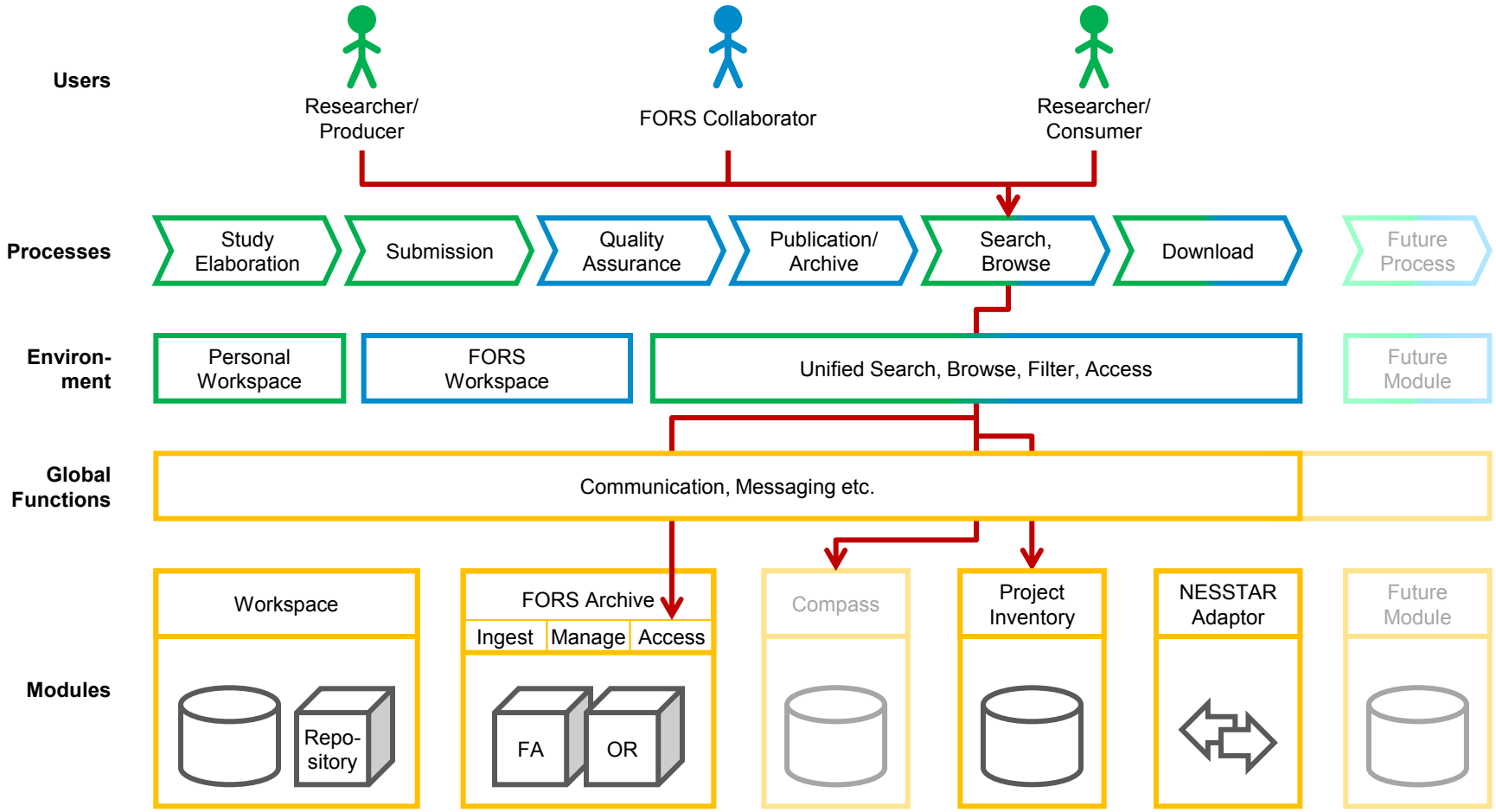

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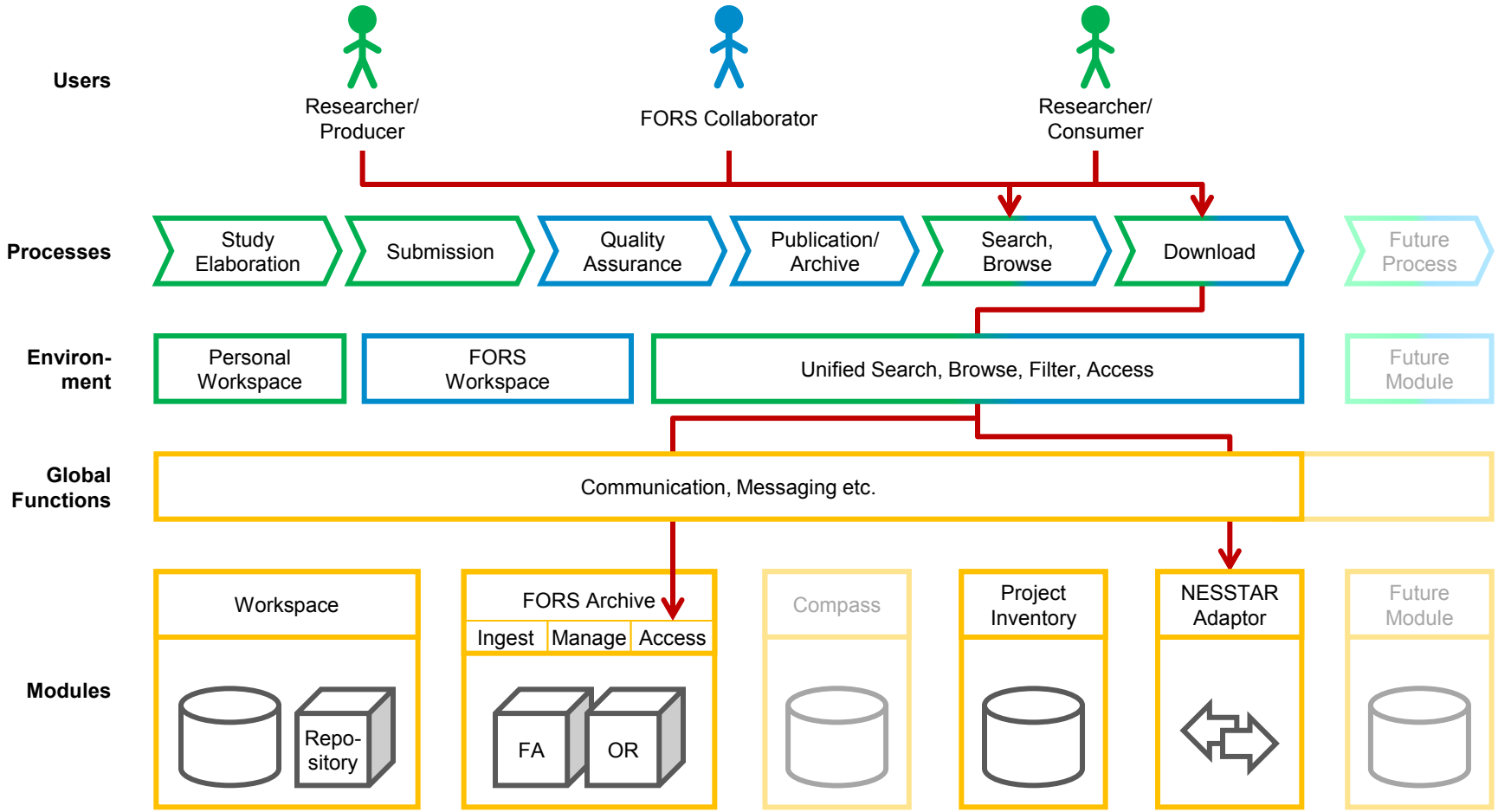

Data management support services

- New deposit and access platform (FORSbase)
- Data management training and consultancy
  - Training for future depositors
  - Training for doctoral students and researchers with 'common' topics such as :

    informed consent
    anonymisation
    data storage
    backup/security
    documentation
    data sharing
    ...

BUT...

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swiss foundation for research in social sciences

Unconventional teaching method !

The Daily

Sunday, August 25, 2013

Research team kidnapped

An entire research team based in London has been kidnapped and held hostage for more than two days, a Scotland Yard spokesman said.

The team of four academics was kidnapped on Friday evening after uniting to celebrate the end of a research project.

Detectives are questioning "a number of people" who might provide clues about the motivation of the kidnapper. It is not known where they are being held.

Scotland Yard's special kidnap unit said it was investigating but would give no further details.

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Data management support services

- New deposit and access platform (FORSbase)
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- Website and guidelines

Data service
Research information
Public statistics – COMPASS
Social indicators
Data management
Visualisation for the social sciences

Data management

Do you have the skills needed in the modern research environment?

Research practices are undergoing an unrecognized revolution in the social sciences, given the effects of new technologies, changing funding mechanisms, and more large team-oriented projects. However, the skills needed to master work in this new environment are currently rarely taught in university degree programs in a systematic and formal way. Specifically, many researchers still lack necessary skills in data management, and so are unable to operate optimally in modern research settings.

Don't let this happen to your data!

Challenges and future directions

- Develop some new fun data management teaching scenarios
- Set the example by applying good data management practices as part of the “Ch-x” project
- Develop guidelines based on our experiences

Last but not least...

- Try to influence funder policy (data management plan, incentives, monitoring)

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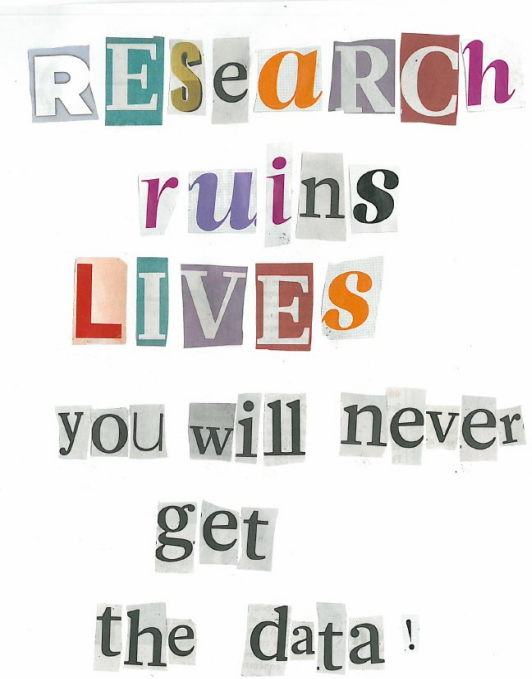
Thanks for your attention !

Alexandra.stam@fors.unil.ch